

Group 2 Project – Prompt Autopsy & Trust But Verify

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From weak prompts to strong prompts – Prompt 1

Original prompt:

What happened to gold in the past few weeks?

Missing:

Role, task, focus, double check, format

Response Transcript:

<https://gemini.google.com/share/d/1jxb0si1qgubUqMQWkkrCWngSPgaaTZ38?usp=sharing>

From weak prompts to strong prompts – Prompt 1 Revised

Improved prompt:

Role: You are a professional gold analysts. You have been following global gold market for many years.

Task: Analyze the main events that affect gold price and explain in a professional way.

Focus: Focus on the reason behind the price and how the event is correlated to gold price

Double check: Output until you are confident of the result

Format: Professional and logic, ready to be review by your manager

Response Transcript:

<https://gemini.google.com/share/d/1jxb0si1qgubUqMQWkkrCWngSPgaaTZ38?usp=sharing>

From weak prompts to strong prompts – Prompt 2

Original prompt: What is going on with interest rates?

Missing: Specificity (time period, country, specific rates), AI role, situational context, exact task

Response Transcript: <https://share.gemini.google/jYMPggrg0zcY>

From weak prompts to strong prompts – Prompt 2 Revised

Improved prompt: You are a fixed-income strategist. Explain what has happened to U.S. interest rates over the past three months through August 28, 2026. Analyze the federal funds target range and the 2-year and 10-year U.S. Treasury yields. Provide the starting level, current level, and change in basis points for each one. Then explain the primary drivers of these movements, focusing on Fed policy and communications, inflation data, labor market and economic growth data, and changes in market expectations for future Fed policy. Explain what the changes imply for borrowing costs, bond prices, equity valuations, and corporate financing conditions.

Use reliable, current sources and provide citations for every numerical figure. Clearly distinguish observed market movements from your interpretation of why they occurred. Present your findings in the form of a concise morning briefing, followed by three main takeaways.

Response Transcript: <https://share.gemini.google/BUEx6qhcWAa2>

From weak prompts to strong prompts – Prompt 3

Original prompt: How did Apple perform last quarter?

Missing: Intention of the analysis, target audience, what aspect of apple to focus, how the report is going to be structured

Response Transcript: <https://gemini.google.com/share/d/1GEQCZ7ePTaL9maDXOSQJvSX1wtj8uGa9?usp=sharing>

From weak prompts to strong prompts – Prompt 3 Revised

Improved prompt (Part 1):

Role: Lead Wall Street Equity Research Analyst covering Apple Inc.
Objective: Write an institutional earnings recap and catalyst analysis for Apple's latest reported quarter.

Structure:

1. Executive Summary: Top-line takeaway on whether the quarter was a beat or miss and the immediate stock price reaction/catalysts.
2. Earnings Scorecard (Table): | Metric | Reported | Consensus Expectation | Y/Y Growth % | Beat / Miss | (Include: Total Revenue, Diluted EPS, Gross Margin %, Services Revenue, iPhone Revenue)
3. Valuation & Stock-Moving Factors: - Management's forward guidance for next quarter. - Capital allocation updates (buyback authorization and cash flow conversion). - Key risks and multi-quarter catalysts (e.g., AI integration, FX headwinds, regulatory environment).

From weak prompts to strong prompts – Prompt 3 Revised (Continued)

Improved prompt (Part 2)

Constraints: Data-driven and objective. Prioritize metrics that directly impact Wall Street discounted cash flow (DCF) models and price targets.

Response Transcript: <https://gemini.google.com/share/d/1OsC4ATl4ETV8KJWxlziLeoYs6Jlj3Gzz?usp=sharing>

From weak prompts to strong prompts – Prompt 4

Original prompt: Analyze Tesla's Q3 performance and tell me if I should buy the stock.

Missing: Which fiscal year, a required source for the financials, which metrics count as "performance," a comparison baseline, the investor's own horizon and risk tolerance, and an output format. It also asks for a verdict the analysis can't support.

Prompt transcript: <https://share.gemini.google/OloXytt36A1h>

From weak prompts to strong prompts – Prompt 4 Revised

Improved prompt (Part 1): Role: Senior automotive sector equity analyst covering Tesla Inc.

Objective: Produce a Q3 FY2025 performance review and a buy-case framework for a retail investor with a five-year horizon and moderate risk tolerance.

Structure:

- Quarter Scorecard (Table): | Metric | Reported | Prior-Year Quarter | Y/Y Change | vs. Company Guidance | (Include: Total Revenue, Automotive Gross Margin excluding regulatory credits, Free Cash Flow, Vehicle Deliveries, Energy Storage Deployments)
- What Drove the Quarter: The two or three factors most responsible for the result, separating one-time items from structural trends.

From weak prompts to strong prompts – Prompt 4 Revised

Improved prompt (Part 2):

- Buy-Case Framework: The conditions under which a five-year holder should buy, hold, or pass, with the specific metrics to watch each quarter. Do not issue a recommendation.
- Constraints: Cite the 10-Q or the quarterly update deck for every figure. Flag any number you cannot source or are uncertain about rather than estimating. Separate GAAP from non-GAAP where both exist.

Prompt Transcript: <https://share.gemini.google/iAdoHhoKPSoH>

Trust, but Verify

Trust, but Verify: AAPL Stock Snapshot

Initial Prompt: Create a one-page stock snapshot for Apple (NASDAQ: AAPL) based on its Q3/2026 financial performance. Include an overview of the company, major business segments, current stock price and valuation, recent financial performance, and key financial metrics. Include visuals where beneficial.

Response Transcript: <https://share.gemini.google/cN3RRNbdBIZQ>

AAPL Snapshot (Q3/26) based on Original AI Output

Executive Highlights:

- **Quarter Ended:** June 27, 2026
- **Stock Price:** \$313.45 (*Market Cap: \$4.57tn*)
- **Total Revenue:** \$109.42Bn (+16.4% YoY)
- **Diluted EPS:** \$2.02 (+28.7% YoY) vs. \$1.57 in Q3/25
- **Net Profit:** \$29.79Bn (+27.1% YoY)
- **Gross Margin:** 50.1% (+360 bps YoY)

Valuation Metrics & Financial Health:

- **P/E Ratio (TTM):** 35.8x (Trailing 12-month EPS: \$8.75) - Trading ~43% above its 10-year historical mean of 25.0x.
- **Cash & Marketable Securities:** \$146.5Bn
- **Term Debt:** \$71.3Bn
- **Dividend:** \$0.27 per share declared (payable August 13, 2026)

AAPL Snapshot: Figure Verification using Revised Prompt

Revised Prompt: Review the one-page Apple Q3/26 stock snapshot you provided in your previous response. Your task is to perform an accuracy audit of your original response rather than generate a new stock snapshot.

Response Transcript: <https://claude.ai/share/edaace94-a99a-477a-b87b-2f27341801ce>

AAPL Snapshot: Error Log

Metric	Original AI Figure	Verified Figure	Verification Source	Classification
Stock Price	\$313.45	\$313.45	Morning Star	✓
Market Cap	\$4.57 Trillion	\$4.57 Trillion	sec.gov	✓
Total Revenue	\$109.42 Bn	\$109.42 Bn	Apple 8-K Ex. 99.1 (SEC)	✓
Diluted EPS	\$2.02	\$2.02	Apple 10-Q, Note 3 (SEC)	✓
TTM EPS	\$8.75	\$8.72	Apple	✗
Net Profit	\$29.79 Bn	\$29.79 Bn	Apple 8-K Ex. 99.1 (SEC)	✓
Gross Margin	50.1%	50.1%	Apple 8-K Ex. 99.1 (SEC)	✓
P/E Ratio (TTM)	35.8x	35.9x	Morningstar	✗
Term Debt	\$71.3 Bn	\$82.3 Bn	Apple 10-Q, Consolidated Balance Sheets (SEC)	✗
Dividend	\$0.27/share	\$0.27/share	Apple Q3 FY26 8-K, Exhibit 99.1	✓